THE NOBULOUS SET · CAMPAIGN SUPPLEMENT

Nobulous Research Journal (NRJ)

Three games. One terrible idea.

The Journal reveals that Build-a-Tyrant (BAT), the Nobulous Apprenticeship Program (NAP) and the Automaton of Shale (AoS) were never separate jobs. NAP supplied the knowledge and the brain, BAT supplied the body, AoS supplied the kidnapping and the cover-up. What remains is to walk the finished Imposter into the Council chamber and survive nine rounds of scrutiny.

COMPONENTS

- 18 NRJ cards for BAT — 6 Experimental Protocols, 6 Unauthorized Modifications, 6 Research Notes
- 14 NRJ cards for NAP — 4 Following Setbacks, 4 Impostor Tasks, 6 Devious Opportunities
- 18 NRJ cards for AoS — 6 Nobulous Interference, 6 Corrupted Limitations, 6 Backdoor Routines
- 24 Council Test Scenario cards
- **From 20 Strong:** the 17 unit dice, the 3 stat dice (Health, Strategy, Recovery) and the Chip
- Plus the components of whichever games you are playing

WHAT NRJ ADDS

NRJ has two independent uses. You may use either, or both.

- **Overlay modules.** Optional cards that interfere with each standalone game. Three tiers per game.
- **The campaign.** Play all three games, carry your results forward, and finish with the Imposter Scenario.

> **THE TIERS ARE NOT DIFFICULTY LEVELS**
>
> **Tier I — Agenda** introduces Nobulous' interference. **Tier II — Contamination** injects corrupted material into the game's own decks and is the pressure peak. **Tier III — Exploitation** gives you tools to exploit the mess. Each tier includes the ones before it.

BUILD-A-TYRANT (BAT) MODULE — 18 CARDS

TIER	ADD
I	Draw 1 of the 6 **Experimental Protocols** at setup.
II	Remove 6 ordinary Upgrades from the Upgrade deck and shuffle the 6 **Unauthorized Modifications** in to replace them. Either a Rat or the Tyrant may hold them.
III	Lay the 6 **Research Notes** face-up beside the table. Each prints its own claim condition; take a Note when you meet it, then spend it later for the one-shot reward printed on it. A Note can be claimed only once, and only one copy of each condition exists.

NOBULOUS APPRENTICESHIP PROGRAM (NAP) MODULE — 14 CARDS

TIER	ADD
I	Set the 6 base Setbacks aside and shuffle in **3 of the 4 Following Setbacks**, chosen at random, exactly where the 3 base Setbacks would have gone. Never use both kinds together. An unresolved Following Setback moves into the next Time Slot, including Evening to the next Morning. A Following Setback does **not** lock the row: the restriction printed on the card replaces "no other Assignment may be worked until this Setback is resolved".
II	Add the 4 **Impostor Tasks**, one per subject. Each replaces a Credit Task of the same subject.
III	Replace the 6 Opportunities with the 6 **Devious Opportunities**.

> **IMPOSTOR TASKS**
>
> Impostor Tasks are **Mandatory** and **grant no Credits**. You still have to clear them; clearing them advances nothing.

DEVIOUS OPPORTUNITIES BANK THEIR HELP

Four of the six pay nothing when you complete them: you **keep the card and spend it once during the Final Exam** — or **discard it during the apprenticeship to ignore one Setback's restrictions for the rest of the game**. That Setback stays in its Time Slot and still has to be resolved; it simply stops charging upkeep and stops restricting what else you may work. The other two — *Borrow the Master's Notes* and *Extra Credit?* — resolve immediately, because an exam has no room for them. Tier III replaces the base Opportunities, so NAP's own coupons are not in the deck at this tier: your Opportunity rewards are **banked for the exams** instead of spent along the way. Spending one is free and costs no dice.

AUTOMATON OF SHALE (AOS) MODULE — 18 CARDS

TIER	ADD
I	Draw 1 of the 6 **Nobulous Interference** cards at setup.
II	Shuffle the 6 **Corrupted Limitations** into the Limitation deck.
III	Lay the 6 **Backdoor Routines** face-up beside the table. Each prints a claim condition and a later one-shot use. **You may claim at most 2 per game** — once you have claimed 2 you cannot claim more, even if you meet the other conditions.

Corrupted Limitations are revealed before required-color dice are committed, exactly like native Limitations, and withhold 2 dice of a *randomly selected* color on top of their printed corruption.

PLAYING THE CAMPAIGN

1. Choose a tier and apply that module to every game you play.
2. Win BAT, NAP and AoS in any order. **If you lose a game, replay that game only** — the campaign does not restart.
3. Each won game contributes 6 cards to the **Research Pool**.
4. Play the Imposter Scenario.

No written bookkeeping is needed. Physical cards and their printed states carry the whole campaign history.

The Research Pool — 18 cards

DOMAIN	RETAINED (3)	CANDIDATES (3)
NAP Knowledge	The 3 Final Exams actually faced	3 unused Final Exams
BAT Physical	Up to 3 Upgrades the Rats held when the battle began, max 1 Specimen — survival does not matter	Cards spliced into the Tyrant, then unused Upgrades; fill BAT to 6
AoS Cover-Up	The 3 Advanced Programs faced, preserving Stable / Overheated	3 unused Advanced Programs

Keep all 18 face-up and available. A card spent or discarded for an effect is gone for the rest of the finale.

THE IMPOSTER SCENARIO

1. Deal 4 Knowledge, 4 Physical and 4 Cover-Up Scenarios at random from the 24-card Council Test library and shuffle those 12 into the Scenario deck.
2. The Imposter begins at **5 HP / 2 STR / 3 REC** with all 17 dice available.
3. Attempt Scenarios until **9 have been attempted**. Avoided Scenarios do not count.
4. After the ninth attempt, win if the Imposter has at least 1 Health. **Reaching 0 Health at any point ends the finale in defeat** — replay the finale, not the campaign.

STR 2 means each attempt is one roll plus one further Strategy roll, unless a Scenario says otherwise. That second roll works the normal way: pick up any dice you have not yet applied — misses, hits, or both — add any further available dice you want, and throw them together. None of it is compulsory, and you choose before anything leaves your hand. A hit is 1 success and a Crit is 2.

Attempting a Scenario

1. Reveal the top Scenario and apply any reveal text.
2. Decide whether to **avoid** it (below). An avoided Scenario does not advance the attempt count.
3. Decide which Research Pool cards to spend. Apply their Target reductions. Spent cards are gone.
4. Commit dice and roll against the modified Target using the normal Strategy procedure.
5. Resolve the Scenario's success or failure text.
6. Recover up to REC exhausted dice — REC falls as Suspicion grows. Advance the attempt count.

You may attempt a Scenario without spending anything.

Spending Research cards

Every Scenario names one category within its domain. A card's value depends on whether it matches:

CARD	REDUCTION
Matching retained — NAP	−2
Matching retained — BAT	−3 (Specimen −5)
Matching retained — AoS	Stable −4, Overheated −2
Retained, wrong category	−2
Candidate or damaged card	0

Avoiding a Scenario

Discard one eligible AoS card from the Research Pool and place the current Scenario on the bottom of the deck without attempting it. Reveal the next one.

- Only **Candidate** Advanced Programs and **retained Overheated** Advanced Programs may be discarded to avoid.
- Retained **Stable** Advanced Programs cannot avoid — they are pure Target reduction.
- Repeated avoidance is legal while eligible AoS cards remain.
- If a Scenario specifies where an avoided card goes, follow its text instead.

Failure and Suspicion

1. Place the failed Scenario face-up in the **Suspicion row**.
2. Choose: lose 1 Health **or** banish 2 available dice.
3. If you cannot banish 2 available dice, Health loss is mandatory.
4. Apply any extra failure text printed on the Scenario.

> **SUSPICION IS UNCAPPED, AND IT COSTS YOU DICE**
>
> Every card in the Suspicion row adds **+1 Target to every later Scenario** unless that Scenario says otherwise. It also costs recovery: **your REC is 3 minus the number of cards in the Suspicion row**, to a minimum of 0. The more the Council suspects you, the less of your pool comes back.

Terminology: the **Research Pool** is always the 18 carried-forward cards. The **dice pool** is the Imposter's dice. Scenario text that discards from the Research Pool never discards a die.

STANDALONE IMPOSTER MODE

You can play the finale without the campaign:

1. Randomly select 3 eligible retained cards from each game.
2. Select 3 more from each game as Candidates.
3. For retained AoS Advanced Programs, randomize Stable versus Overheated independently.
4. For BAT, keep the limit of at most 1 Specimen.
5. Build the 12-card Scenario deck normally and play the nine-attempt finale.